

CSS Introduction

What is CSS?

CSS stands for **Cascading Style Sheets**. It is a language used to make websites look beautiful by controlling colors, fonts, spacing, and layouts. While HTML provides the structure (like headings, paragraphs, buttons), CSS makes it look nice.

Think of it this way:

- **HTML** = The skeleton (structure)
- **CSS** = The skin, clothes, and makeup (appearance)

How to Use CSS

There are three ways to add CSS to your website:

1. Inline CSS

Write CSS directly in the HTML tag:

```
<p style="color: blue; font-size: 18px;">
  This is blue text
</p>
```

2. Internal CSS

Write CSS inside a `<style>` tag in your HTML file:

```
<head>
  <style>
    p {
      color: blue;
      font-size: 18px;
    }
  </style>
</head>
```

3. External CSS

Create a separate `.css` file and link it to your HTML:

```
<head>
  <link rel="stylesheet" href="styles.css">
</head>
```

Basic CSS Syntax

```
selector {
  property: value;
  property: value;
}
```

Example:

```
h1 {
  color: red;
  font-size: 32px;
  text-align: center;
}
```

Here, `h1` is the **selector**, `color` and `font-size` are **properties**, and `red` and `32px` are **values**.

Common CSS Properties

Text Fonts

- `color` — Change text color
- `font-size` — Make text bigger or smaller
- `font-family` — Change the font style
- `text-align` — Align text (left, center, right)
- `font-weight` — Make text bold

Colors & Backgrounds

- `background-color` — Change background color
- `background-image` — Add a background picture

Spacing

- `margin` — Space outside an element
- `padding` — Space inside an element

Borders & Size

- `border` — Add a border around an element
- `width` — Set element width
- `height` — Set element height

Simple Example

HTML:

```
<h1>Welcome</h1>
<p>This is a paragraph.</p>
```

CSS:

```
h1 {
  color: blue;
  text-align: center;
}

p {
  color: green;
  font-size: 16px;
  margin: 20px;
}
```

Classes and IDs

You can style specific elements using **classes** and **IDs**:

Class (use `.`):

```
.highlight {
  background-color: yellow;
}

<p class="highlight">This is highlighted</p>
```

ID (use `#`):

```
#header {  
  color: white;  
  background-color: navy;  
}  
  
<div id="header">Header Section</div>
```

Tips

- Always use external CSS files for larger projects
- Use meaningful names for classes and IDs
- Keep your CSS organized and easy to read
- Test your website in different browsers

Next Steps

Now that you know the basics, explore:

- Flexbox for layouts
- Grid for advanced positioning
- Animations and transitions
- Responsive design for mobile devices